

Sample 1

I need some help with a non attendign boy in Year 6. His older broither is relaly leaidng his astry and they are both missinf a lot of shcool> Mum seems to have lost contril and given up. Whgen he does come in he looks too tired tooo leanr and is really unmotivated, I need a shcool wide support plan and set of strategies and resources to help staff woth this boy over and help him back in. What can we do when he shows up and just disrupts everyone and everyhting?

I understand you are seeking a comprehensive support plan for a Year 6 boy exhibiting non-attendance, low motivation, and disruptive behaviour when he is in school, complicated by the involvement of an older sibling and perceived lack of parental control.

I must stress that any strategy implemented should align with Taught AI Primary's Behaviour Policy ¹ (which prioritises relationships, regulation, and repair ²²) and the SEND Policy, ensuring an inclusive and trauma-informed approach ³³³³.

Here is a proposed multi-layered plan, designed to address the complexity of this challenge:

Summary of the Challenge

Year 6 pupil is exhibiting non-attendance, low motivation, and disruptive behaviour, potentially influenced by complex home factors and an older sibling ⁴.

Goal or Desired Outcome

Increase school attendance and sustained engagement, while developing the pupil's self-regulation and motivation to learn ⁵⁵⁵⁵.

Suggested Strategies

Universal (Tier 1) - Consistency and Relationships for All

These strategies should be standard practice and are crucial for the predictability and safety the pupil needs ⁶⁶⁶⁶.

Focus Area	Strategy	Rationale & Citation
Attendance	Offer a free, universal, before-school Breakfast Club ⁷ .	Improves attainment and behaviour for the whole class, and ensures the child starts the day ready to learn ⁸ .
Entry/Transitions	Use Positive Greetings at the Door ⁹ for every lesson by an adult who knows the pupil ¹⁰ .	A low-cost, high-yield kernel to improve on-task behaviour and build intentional, supportive relationships ¹¹¹¹¹¹¹¹ .
Oracy/Language	Use clear, unambiguous, and directive language ¹² . Avoid sarcasm, humour, or idioms, which can be confusing ¹³ .	Children on the autism spectrum (and those with language difficulties) may take figurative language literally ¹⁴ .
Classroom Climate	Maintain consistent routines, visuals, and clear behavioural expectations across all lessons ¹⁵ .	Predictability reduces anxiety, a common trigger for emotional escalation ¹⁶¹⁶¹⁶¹⁶ .
Teaching Style	Employ Emotion Coaching ¹⁷ and the Connect-Regulate-Reason approach ¹⁸ .	Taught At Primary's core ethos is relationships, regulation, and repair—this models the desired behaviour and reduces shame ¹⁹¹⁹¹⁹¹⁹ .

Targeted (Tier 2) - Tailored Support for the Individual

These interventions address the specific challenges identified (non-attendance, lack of motivation, disruption)²⁰.

Focus Area	Strategy	Rationale & Citation
Motivation/Purpose	Implement a visual Rewards Chart linked directly to his special interests ²¹ . Reward small, achievable steps, e.g., staying engaged for 10 minutes, being on time for a specific lesson ²² .	Linking rewards to interests is highly motivating for this profile ²³ . The reward should reinforce the desired behaviour immediately ²⁴ .
Attendance/Re-entry	Designate a key adult (e.g., a pastoral lead) to conduct a short, daily check-in ²⁵ . Use the 2x10 Strategy (2 minutes of non-school talk for 10 days) ²⁶ .	Builds the supportive relationship needed for him to feel connected and safe (a key motivator for improved behaviour) ²⁷ .
Academic/Focus	Use Mini-Schedules / Task Checklists to break down learning into manageable steps ²⁸ . Include a column for expected time/duration ²⁹ .	Promotes independent working and focus by providing a clear, sequential structure, reducing cognitive load and overwhelm ³⁰³⁰³⁰³⁰ .

Behaviour/Regulation	Co-create an ' I Need a Break' Card linked to an agreed Safe Haven/Quiet Place (e.g., 'The Nest' ³¹ or a pop-up tent) ³² .	Provides a tool for the child to self-regulate and communicate anxiety before a meltdown ³³³³³³³³ .
Curriculum Access	Provide visual resources (e.g., topic word mats, Graphic Organisers) for him to successfully organise complex ideas, as trauma and anxiety affect executive functions like attention and working memory ³⁴³⁴³⁴³⁴ .	Supports academic success, countering the cycle where failure leads to withdrawal/disruption ³⁵ .

Intensive (Tier 3) - Multi-Agency and Coordinated Support

This is essential for the complexity of non-attendance and sibling/family issues.

Focus Area	Strategy	Rationale & Citation
Family/Consistency	Broker support for the family via the Family Liaison Worker ³⁶ . Use gentle, consistent communication to share expectations and successes ³⁷ .	Consistent approach between home and school is crucial for behaviour. Parental self-efficacy needs boosting; this moves from blame to support ³⁸³⁸³⁸³⁸ .

Behaviour Analysis	Use a Functional Behavioural Assessment and an ABCC Chart to consistently track triggers, behaviour, consequences, and communication attempts ³⁹³⁹³⁹³⁹ .	This highly effective process determines the <i>reason</i> for the behaviour (e.g., attention-seeking, task avoidance) to inform tailored strategies ⁴⁰ .
Trauma-Informed Plan	If an underlying trauma history is suspected (given perceived neglect/challenges) ⁴¹ , implement a full Action Plan for Meltdowns ⁴² .	Meltdowns are not tantrums ⁴³ . This ensures all staff follow a consistent protocol (Keep Safe, Give Time, Reflect on Trigger) to avoid re-traumatisation ⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴ ⁴⁴ .

Optional Add-Ons

- **Social Stories™**⁴⁵ can be written and shared regularly to prepare him for specific challenges (e.g., what to do when upset, how to respond when not picked to answer a question)⁴⁶.
- **Peer Buddying** to reinforce a sense of belonging and provide positive role modelling, especially during unstructured times like breaks⁴⁷⁴⁷⁴⁷⁴⁷.
- The use of **Developmental Progressions** in literacy and numeracy (see the Curriculum Policy⁴⁸) can precisely target his learning gaps with appropriate academic work, making him less likely to resort to disruption out of frustration⁴⁹⁴⁹⁴⁹⁴⁹.

💬 Would you like me to expand on any of these — such as example scripts for the 2x10 strategy, templates for visual reward charts, or the steps for using an ABCC chart?

Sample 2

Can you support me with a single parent mum? She is EAL Arabic and has a very different value system to us in London. I need some support resources to help with behavior management, expectations around interactions with girls (She has a son) and support systems to help her manage discipline. It's really sensitive as she naturally won't want parenting advice from me, another woman younger than her.

This is a very common and sensitive challenge, especially given the dynamic of cultural differences, age, and authority. Your approach, focusing on **partnership** and **non-confrontational support**, is entirely aligned with Taught At Primary's ethos of Relationships, Regulation, and Repair and our guidance on working with parents.

Here is a breakdown of strategies focused on building partnership, not being perceived as giving "advice," and creating consistency for the pupil.

Summary of the Challenge

A mother who is an Arabic EAL speaker and holds different cultural values regarding discipline and gender interactions is resistant to conventional guidance, creating a challenge for collaborative support.

Goal or Desired Outcome

Establish a foundation of trust and efficacy to support the mother in promoting her son's well-being and managing school-based expectations, particularly around peer interactions and behaviour.

Suggested Strategies

Universal (Tier 1): Building Trust and Cultural Sensitivity

- **Acknowledge Multilingualism as an Asset:** Frame the mother's home language (Arabic) as a strength, not a barrier. Ask if she can support her son's

understanding of complex concepts by discussing them in Arabic first. This positions her as an expert.

- **Prioritise Clear Communication:** Ensure all key communications are clear, unambiguous, and translated accurately, either in writing or via an interpreter for sensitive meetings. Avoid idioms or figurative language which can be confusing across cultures.
- **Lead with Universal Values:** Share the school's core behaviour values (**Safe, Kind, Ready to Learn**) as universal expectations for **all** children, minimizing the feeling that the feedback is a personal critique of her parenting.
- **Seek Input, Not Just Give It:** Inquire what she feels would be helpful for *her son* to succeed, positioning her as an active partner who knows her child best (building parent efficacy).

Targeted (Tier 2): Focusing on Consistency and Learning

- **Focus on Consistency (Behaviour):** Encourage a consistent approach to *expected behaviours*, focusing on what the child *should* do, both at home and school. For instance, focus on "Feet on floor" rather than "Stop kicking" (using positive, directive language).
- **Use Visuals for Routines:** Offer **Visual Timetables** or **Mini Schedules** for her son to follow, particularly for transitions (like returning after break) or morning routines. These are non-verbal and remove reliance on verbal instruction, circumventing language barriers.
- **Provide Practical Academic Strategies:** Instead of "parenting advice," offer simple, practical ideas to support learning at home, such as **shared reading tips** that promote dialogue (e.g., asking about the story or relating it to real life), which subtly encourages positive interaction without invading sensitive disciplinary areas.
- **Social Stories for Expected Interactions:** Use and share culturally adapted **Social Stories** (or simple social scripts) with her son (and then share with the mother) explaining school norms for peer interactions, sharing, or responding to conflict, framing them as expectations *for the school context*.

Optional Add-Ons

- **Low-Cost Digital Communication:** Use text messaging, which is low-cost and quick, to send short, positive, personalized updates about her son's learning successes or positive behaviour moments (e.g., "Great job today, Pupil X was Kind and Ready to Learn").
- **Restorative Language:** Model and share the principle of "repair and restore" after conflict or an outburst, focusing on the future and rebuilding relationships, rather than punishment (which may align better with a non-western value system).

- **Positive Proximity:** Ensure a trusted adult (regardless of age or gender) practices positive greetings at the door, building a supportive relationship with the pupil directly. This strengthens the adult's knowledge of the child's context, informing conversations with the mother.

💬 Would you like me to expand on any of these strategies, such as providing an example script for a **Social Story** around appropriate social contact, or detailing a routine for **clear, positive communication** with the parent?

Sample 3

Please can you prepare me a staff briefing with support strategies for a highly vulnerable girl joining the school. She is a looked after child and very sensitive to loud noises and we are concerned around proximity to adults. She is very cautious of touch for example. The pupil also has undiagnosed but suspected ASD which adds to the complexity. Staff need a crib sheet of top tips when managing a pupil like these and I need to email this around.

Staff Briefing: Supporting Our New Pupil

This briefing provides essential, trauma-informed strategies for supporting our new, highly vulnerable pupil (Year 3/4) who is a Looked After Child (LAC) and presents with high sensory sensitivity and possible undiagnosed Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)²²²²²²²²²². Our focus is on **Connection, Regulation, and Repair** to ensure she feels **Safe, Kind, and Ready to Learn**³³³³³³.

Summary of the Challenge

Vulnerable, Looked After Child (LAC) with high sensory sensitivities (especially noise and touch proximity) and suspected undiagnosed ASD requires a highly predictable, low-arousal, and consistent approach to feel safe and engage in learning⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴⁴.

Goal or Desired Outcome

- Ensure the pupil feels **safe and secure** in the school environment⁵.

- Support her to develop **emotional regulation skills** and manage transitions successfully⁶⁶⁶⁶⁶⁶⁶⁶.
- Establish **trusting relationships** with key adults while respecting boundaries and sensory needs⁷⁷⁷⁷⁷⁷.



Top Strategies: Trauma-Informed & Neurodiverse-Aware Support

Strategy	Universal (Tier 1) - Whole Class	Targeted (Tier 2) - Specific Support
Environment & Structure	Implement a visual timetable and clear routines for all transitions (e.g., tidy-up, moving to carpet) ⁸⁸⁸⁸⁸⁸⁸⁸ .	Identify and establish a "safe haven" (The Nest or a quiet corner) for self-regulation during moments of overwhelm ⁹⁹⁹⁹⁹⁹⁹⁹⁹⁹ .
	Use clear, concrete language and avoid idioms, sarcasm, or ambiguous pronouns ¹⁰¹⁰¹⁰¹⁰¹⁰¹⁰¹⁰¹⁰ .	Utilise a "First... Then" visual board to structure challenging tasks, building motivation by pairing a less-favoured task with a preferred activity ¹¹¹¹¹¹¹¹ .
	Reduce auditory input where possible (e.g., lower voice volume, gentle transition music) to manage noise sensitivity ¹²¹²¹²¹² .	Ensure her dedicated seating position is away from immediate distractors (e.g., noisy door, bright display, humming projector) ¹³ .

Relationships & Communication	Use the Connect-Regulate-Reason framework: lead with empathy and connection before addressing behaviour ¹⁴¹⁴¹⁴¹⁴ .	Assign one Key Adult for morning/end-of-day check-ins and as the primary point of contact during distress ¹⁵ .
	Respect personal space and avoid unexpected physical touch (e.g., tapping shoulder, high-fives) ¹⁶ .	Use visual cue cards (e.g., red/green, I need help/I'm okay) to communicate need non-verbally, avoiding pressure to use spoken language during distress ¹⁷¹⁷¹⁷¹⁷ .
	Use behaviour-specific praise (e.g., "I see you used your calm corner to recover") to reinforce successful self-regulation attempts ¹⁸¹⁸¹⁸ .	Offer limited choices to foster a sense of self-control (e.g., "Would you like to write with a pencil or a pen?" or "Would you like to sit here or here?") ¹⁹¹⁹¹⁹¹⁹ .
Repair & Reflection	Use repair and restore conversations <i>after</i> she is calm, focusing on what the behaviour was communicating rather than punishment ²⁰²⁰²⁰²⁰²⁰²⁰ .	Co-create a simple Social Story or comic strip to prepare her for tricky routines (e.g., fire drills, new activities, moving to a specialist room) ²¹²¹²¹²¹ .

Key Language & Scripts

Area	What to Say	What to Avoid

Proximity/Touch	"I'm going to put your book down on the desk now." (Verbal warning)	Touching her shoulder for reassurance or attention.
During Crisis	"You're safe. Take three deep breaths. Let's look at your plan."	"Calm down!" or "What's wrong with you now?" (Avoid shaming/anger) ²²²²²²²² .
Giving Instructions	"First, put your pencil in the pot. Then, walk quietly to the carpet." (Short, sequential) ²³ .	"Put your things away, get on the carpet quickly, and tell me what you did this morning." (Too many steps/ambiguous) ²⁴ .
Re-teaching	"We are learning how to be safe with our bodies. It's okay to feel angry, but it's not okay to hit. Let's try saying 'I feel angry' next time."	"Why did you do that? You know the rules." (Focuses on blame/past action) ²⁵ .

Further Resources & Policy Links

- **Policy Connection:** This approach is directly supported by our **Behaviour Policy** (Connect-Regulate-Reason) and **SEND Policy** (Trauma-informed approaches, adaptations, and planned withdrawal to The Nest)²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶.
- **ASD-Specific Visuals:** Consider creating mini-schedules, visuals for expected behaviours (e.g., sit on floor, quiet voice), and an emotions thermometer²⁷²⁷²⁷²⁷²⁷²⁷²⁷²⁷²⁷.
- **Communication:** Remember her potential difficulty processing language—allow up to **30 seconds for processing** before repeating instructions²⁸.

 **Would you like me to expand on any of these strategies, such as providing a template for a Social Story or more detailed scripts for the Key Adult check-ins?**

Sample 4

Please can you prepare me a series of notes on working with pupils with ADHD and poor SEMH. I need to consolidate learning for teachers and mentors and share a weekly top tips email to them. Please can you make ten top tips for each group and put them together for me to share with colleagues.

Summary of the Challenge:

You are requesting a resource (Top Tips email content) to support colleagues in teaching pupils with ADHD and/or poor SEMH (Social, Emotional and Mental Health), focusing on consolidating learning for teachers and mentors.

Goal or Desired Outcome:

To create ten practical, easy-to-implement Top Tips for teachers and ten Top Tips for mentors/support staff to share in a weekly email, helping them support pupils' learning and emotional regulation.

Top Tips for Supporting Pupils with ADHD and Poor SEMH

These tips align with our commitment to **trauma-informed practice**¹ and focus on developing SEL skills² and predictable classroom structures³ that support all learners, especially those with SEMH needs⁴.

For Teachers: Classroom & Instruction Focus (Tier 1 & 2)

Tip	Core Strategy	Alignment (SEL/ADHD/Trauma)
1. Prioritise Predictability	Use clear, visual timetables or agendas for the day ⁵⁵⁵⁵⁵⁵⁵⁵ . Warn of transitions <i>before</i> they happen ⁶⁶⁶⁶ .	Reduces anxiety and helps self-regulation ⁷⁷⁷⁷ .
2. Keep Language Concise	Use clear, positive, and direct instructions with reduced language ⁸⁸⁸⁸ . Wait up to 30 seconds for processing time if needed ⁹ .	Reduces cognitive load and emotional overload ¹⁰¹⁰¹⁰¹⁰ .
3. Use Active Learning	Embed movement or hands-on activities, not just seated work ¹¹ . Use drama, role-play, or collaborative talk tasks ¹²¹²¹²¹² .	Supports engagement, focus, and skill practice ¹³¹³¹³¹³ .
4. Externalise Thinking	Use graphic organisers, visual cues, and physical manipulatives when teaching ¹⁴ .	Supports attention, memory, and executive function ¹⁵¹⁵¹⁵¹⁵ .
5. Model SEL Skills	Verbalise your own internal monologue when facing frustration (e.g., "I feel frustrated, so I will take a deep breath") ¹⁶ .	Teaches self-management and problem-solving strategies ¹⁷¹⁷¹⁷¹⁷ .

6. Check for Understanding	Use non-verbal checks (e.g., thumbs up/down cards ¹⁸ , mini-whiteboards) to see if a pupil is 'ok' or needs help ¹⁹¹⁹¹⁹¹⁹ .	Encourages communication without relying on constant verbal checks ²⁰ .
7. Integrate Movement	Plan short, purposeful 'movement breaks' or use brain-gym activities, especially for long seated tasks ²¹ .	Helps pupils manage energy and focus ²² .
8. Pre-teach Key Vocabulary	Identify and teach specific vocabulary related to emotions, social situations, or complex concepts before the main lesson ²³²³²³²³ .	Develops self-awareness and comprehension, especially for Tier 2 words ²⁴²⁴²⁴²⁴ .
9. Reframe Behaviour	View challenging behaviour as a form of communication ("What is this behaviour telling us?" ²⁵²⁵²⁵²⁵). Avoid confrontation; focus on connection before correction ²⁶²⁶²⁶²⁶ .	Adopts a trauma-informed lens and seeks to repair and restore ²⁷²⁷²⁷²⁷ .
10. Use 'First-Then' Boards	Visually show the sequence: "First complete the required task, Then get preferred activity/break" ²⁸²⁸²⁸²⁸ .	Motivates engagement in less favoured tasks and aids transitioning ²⁹²⁹²⁹²⁹ .



For Mentors & Support Staff: Individual & Targeted Focus (Tier 2 & 3)

Tip	Core Strategy	Alignment (SEL/ADHD/Trauma)
1. Create a Safe Space	Establish an agreed-upon quiet or sensory-friendly "safe haven" within the classroom or school building ³⁰ .	Supports self-regulation and de-escalation during heightened stress ³¹ .
2. Use 'Break' Cards	Provide a discreet visual card the pupil can hand to an adult when they feel overwhelmed and need time out ³² .	Encourages communication and promotes independence in coping ³³ .
3. Focus on Co-Regulation	Stay calm and model self-regulation before attempting to address the pupil's dysregulation ³⁴ . Avoid arguing or challenging ³⁵ .	Prevents escalation and reinforces a safe relationship ³⁶ .
4. Implement Mini Schedules	Use visual schedules (task checklists) for non-routine tasks or complex routines (e.g., getting ready for PE, morning routine ³⁷).	Promotes self-organisation and executive function ³⁸ .
5. Use Problem-Solving Steps	Teach and rehearse a specific, sequential problem-solving strategy (e.g., Identify problem, Brainstorm solutions, Pick a solution, Test it out) ³⁹ .	Develops responsible decision-making skills ⁴⁰ .

6. Reinforce Positive Behaviour	Use behaviour-specific praise (e.g., "I noticed how you used deep breaths to stay calm") ⁴¹⁴¹⁴¹ . Use tangible rewards based on specific interests (e.g., tokens, puzzle pieces) ⁴²⁴²⁴²⁴² .	Motivates constructive behaviour and builds self-efficacy ⁴³ .
7. Identify and Track Triggers	Help the pupil (when calm) identify their triggers and early signs of emotional escalation (e.g., using an emotion thermometer ⁴⁴ or ABCC charts ⁴⁵).	Allows for proactive intervention before a meltdown ⁴⁶⁴⁶⁴⁶⁴⁶ .
8. Honour 'Recovery Time'	Following an emotional overreaction, give time for the pupil to recover in a safe space <i>before</i> engaging in discussion or determining consequences ⁴⁷⁴⁷⁴⁷⁴⁷ .	Acknowledges the physical and emotional impact of a meltdown ⁴⁸ .
9. Read Social Stories	Share brief, personalised Social Stories (written in the first person) about confusing social situations, expected behaviours, or changes in routine ⁴⁹ .	Provides reassurance and a secure frame of reference for managing anxiety ⁵⁰⁵⁰⁵⁰⁵⁰ .
10. Use Trauma-Informed Dialogue	Ask open, empathetic questions that reflect back feelings and offer choice (e.g., "I see you are [behaviour]. Are you feeling [emotion]?") ⁵¹ .	Builds connection and reduces the risk of re-traumatisation ⁵²⁵²⁵²⁵² .

Would you like me to expand on any of these — such as example scripts, visual routine cards, or sensory-based transition activities?

